BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #32 · BRAIN INJURY AND MEMORY

"I'm stupid now."

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Where it often comes from

Slower thinking, trouble finding words, and forgetfulness after injury or illness can feel humiliating, especially to those once quick and capable. Others' impatience can deepen shame.

What Scripture teaches

"The foolishness of God is wiser than man's wisdom, and the weakness of God is stronger than man's strength" (1 Corinthians 1:25). "For the LORD gives wisdom; from His mouth come knowledge and understanding" (Proverbs 2:6). "The unfolding of Your words gives light; it informs the simple" (Psalm 119:130). Wisdom is more than speed: it includes humility, kindness, faith, and love. Your intelligence is one part of you, and it is not the source of your worth.

> *"For the LORD gives wisdom; from His mouth come knowledge and understanding"* (Proverbs 2:6).

Also see

> "For the foolishness of God is wiser than man's wisdom, and the weakness of God is stronger than man's strength" (1 Corinthians 1:25).

> "The unfolding of Your words gives light; it informs the simple" (Psalm 119:130).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "The heart of the discerning acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks it out" (Proverbs 18:15).

Common self-statements

- I cannot think anymore.
- I used to be smart.
- Everyone sees how slow I am.
- I am an embarrassment.
- I make mistakes all the time.
- I am dumb.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either smart or stupid.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always struggle.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling slow and concluding I am stupid.
- Labeling: Calling myself stupid.

Challenging questions

- What can I still do well?
- How has my thinking changed, and what helps?
- What strategies, like lists, routines, and extra time, help?

- What qualities of wisdom do I still have?
- What would I say to a friend who had the same injury?
- Whom can I ask for patience and help?

Truth summary

> I am not stupid. My thinking has changed, and I can use tools and patient help. Wisdom is a gift from God that includes more than speed. My worth is secure.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Wisdom
- Humility
- Suffering
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'm stupid now"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm stupid now." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What can I still do well?
- ☐ How has my thinking changed, and what helps?
- ☐ What strategies, like lists, routines, and extra time, help?
- ☐ What qualities of wisdom do I still have?
- ☐ What would I say to a friend who had the same injury?
- ☐ Whom can I ask for patience and help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord gives wisdom.
- ☐ God's Word informs the simple.
- ☐ Wisdom is more than speed.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ I can use tools that help.
- ☐ I can ask for patience.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 2:6
  "For the LORD gives wisdom; from His mouth come knowledge and understanding."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 1:25
  "For the foolishness of God is wiser than man's wisdom, and the weakness of God is stronger than man's strength."
- ☐ Psalm 119:130
  "The unfolding of Your words gives light; it informs the simple."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Wise in other ways: Each week, note one thing you handled well.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Proverbs 2:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord gives wisdom, and my worth is not my speed.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Wisdom" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Use tools. Try lists, calendars, and reminders.
- ☐ Take your time. Ask for more time without apology.
- ☐ Name strengths. Write ten abilities that remain.
- ☐ Pray Proverbs 2:6. Ask God for wisdom.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm stupid now": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Wise in other ways
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm stupid now.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my mind feels slow. Give me wisdom, patience, and tools that help, and remind me that my worth is in You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.